WHILE YOU WERE AWAY



By Sheena Keding (Mommy)



While you were away, I missed you every day. I counted the stars and whispered your name. My heart stayed right beside you.



Even when we couldn't talk, I was thinking of you. I imagined your smile, your giggles, your brave little self.



I hoped you were splashing, laughing, playing. I pictured you having adventures-even if I missed you terribly.



When the calls were short or we couldn't talk much, I knew you still loved me-just like I love you.



We counted the days until you came back to me. Every day, I said: 'Josslynn is brave. Josslynn is strong. Josslynn is so loved.'



Zazu perched by the window,
watching and waiting.
Nala curled up on your bed,
sniffing your bunny and missing
your giggles.



I wrote little notes for you—
One for every hug I wanted to give,
Every laugh I missed,
Every time I whispered,
“I love you.”



While you were away,
Janie peeked into your room
sometimes—
just to feel a little closer to you.



And now you're home!

I'm so proud of you.

You did a big, brave

thing.



And guess what? You'll always be my baby.

Forever and ever.

For Josslynn
My brave, bright, beautiful girl.
This book is for the moments we couldn't be together,
but were never really apart.
It's for your big heart, your strong spirit,
and the love that connects us—
no matter how many miles or days.
It's for the strength you showed,
the joy you brought home,
and the hugs we saved up for your return.
Zazu missed your laughter.
Nala missed your cuddles.
And Janie and I missed your little sparkle.
You are deeply loved,
forever and always.

Love always,
Mama˙ 



Created for Josslynn Jones

By Sheena Keding (Mommy)